WINTER 2026/27 EDITION

Securing Remote Access to Industrial Machines in Belgium and the Netherlands

A regulatory and buyer's guide, winter 2026/27

A regional guide with an original size-class analysis, not a market study.

Data extracted on 21 October 2026.

Contents

1. Executive summary
2. The two countries compared
3. Regulatory timeline
4. How remote access works in practice
5. Trade-offs
6. Buyer's evaluation matrix
7. Illustrative scenarios
8. A 90-day action plan
9. Sources and methodology

PART 1

Executive summary

Five findings, each traceable to a specific source cited where it appears in this report. None is this report's own judgment call.

1. NIS2 is already in force in both countries, on different national implementation timelines. Belgium: **18 October 2024** (Source: Law of 26 April 2024 (Moniteur belge), Art. 98, checked 19 October 2026). Netherlands: **15 August 2026** (Source: Staatsblad 2026, 187 and 189 (Art. 35), checked 19 October 2026).

   Source: lib/compliance-ledger.ts, ids nis2-be and nis2-nl

2. The Cyber Resilience Act and the Machinery Regulation bind the product placed on the market, not the organization placing it, so neither is gated by the same size threshold as NIS2's own organizational rules.

   Source: lib/compliance-ledger.ts, ids cra-reporting, cra-full, machinery-regulation; SUPPLEMENTARY_EVIDENCE id cra-scope-art2-1

3. Across both countries, most machinery and equipment manufacturers (NACE C28) are small by headcount: enterprises with 50 or more persons employed are 8.9% of the total in Belgium and 9.5% in the Netherlands, both minorities.

   Source: lib/eurostat-data.ts, Eurostat sbs_sc_ovw, 2024, extracted 2026-10-21

4. NIS2 Article 21(2)(d) requires an in-scope company to assess the security of its direct suppliers, which creates a documented commercial path for the same questions to reach a machine builder or integrator NIS2 doesn't bind directly, through that supplier's own customer.

   Source: lib/compliance-ledger.ts, SUPPLEMENTARY_EVIDENCE id nis2-article-21-2-d

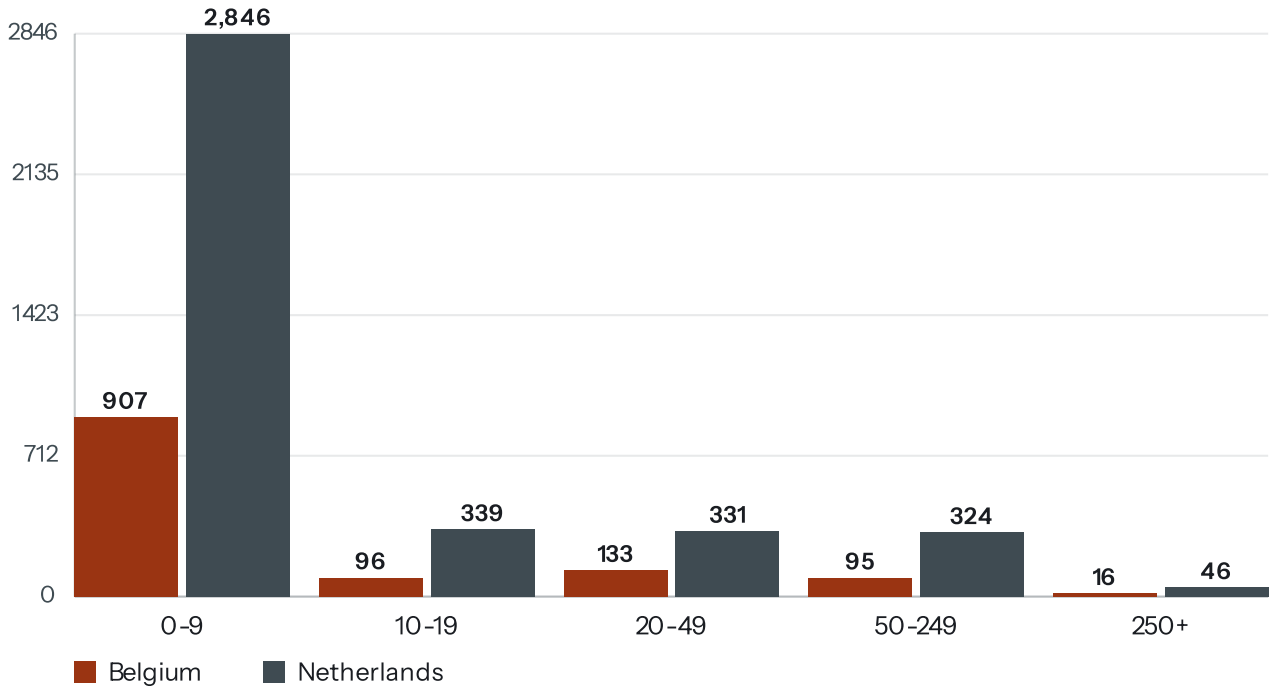
5. The two countries route registration and incident reporting through different national authorities on different clocks: Belgium's Centre for Cybersecurity Belgium with a 24-hour early warning and 72-hour notification, the Netherlands' RDI/NCSC pairing with the same 24-and-72-hour structure but its own registration process.

   Source: lib/country-report.ts country sections for BE and NL, sourced from lib/compliance-ledger.ts SUPPLEMENTARY_EVIDENCE ids be-nis2-* and nl-cbw-*

PART 2

The two countries compared

NIS2's own size test is headcount, or annual turnover, or annual balance sheet total, whichever a company meets first, and it counts linked and partner enterprises together, not any single legal entity in isolation. The enterprise counts in this section use headcount (persons employed) as a public, comparable proxy across both countries. That proxy is useful for sizing the regional picture; it is not a scope determination for any specific company, which depends on the full three-part test applied to that company's own linked group.



Enterprises in NACE C28 (machinery and equipment n.e.c.) by persons-employed size class, 2024. Share with 50 or more persons employed: Belgium 8.9%, Netherlands 9.5%. Source: Eurostat, dataset sbs_sc_ovw, extracted 21 October 2026.

The same 50-or-more-employed share for the five related NACE codes this report also pulled (computer/electronic/optical products, electrical equipment, motor vehicles, other transport equipment, and repair and installation of machinery), for context:

NACE code	Belgium: total / 50+ share	Netherlands: total / 50+ share
C26 Computer, electronic and optical products	380 / 9.7%	1,889 / 4.7%
C27 Electrical equipment	505 / 6.5%	1,427 / 5.3%
C29 Motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers	499 / 8.2%	930 / 6.2%

NACE code	Belgium: total / 50+ share	Netherlands: total / 50+ share
C30 Other transport equipment	187 / 6.4%	1,564 / 3.5%
C33 Repair and installation of machinery and equipment	4,679 / 1.6%	14,762 / 0.9%

Source: Eurostat, dataset sbs_sc_ovw, 2024, extracted 21 October 2026. Cross-check: CBS (Statistics Netherlands), table 81589NED, SBI 28, Q4 2026 (provisional, per CBS), extracted 21 October 2026: 3,565 total enterprises, 370 with 50 or more employed, corroborating the Eurostat Netherlands figure in enterprise count though not in total (a quarterly business-register snapshot, not the same survey). Statbel's open-data portal and API were reachable on the extraction date, but no directly comparable published size-class breakdown for NACE 28 could be resolved. Belgium's figures in this report rest on Eurostat alone.

Supervisory authority, registration, and incident reporting

Belgium

In force since: 18 October 2024

Supervisory authority: Arrêté royal du 9 juin 2024 (Moniteur belge), Art. 3 §1

Registration step: Law of 26 April 2024 (Moniteur belge), Art. 13 §1

Incident-reporting duty: Law of 26 April 2024 (Moniteur belge), Art. 35 §1

Netherlands

In force since: 15 August 2026

Supervisory authority: NCSC-NL, Cyberbeveiligingswet (NIS2) referral-tree overview

Registration step: RDI, “Registratieplicht Cyberbeveiligingswet”

Incident-reporting duty: NCSC-NL, “Meld incidenten onder de Cyberbeveiligingswet (meldplicht)”

PART 3

Regulatory timeline

Countdowns below are computed as of this edition's date and will not update after printing; see the open web page for a live countdown.

● **NIS2 in force in Belgium (Law of 26 April 2024)**

18 October 2024 · in force as of the edition date

Source: Law of 26 April 2024 (Moniteur belge), Art. 98, checked 19 October 2026

● **Cyberbeveiligingswet (NIS2) in force in the Netherlands**

15 August 2026 · in force as of the edition date

Source: Staatsblad 2026, 187 and 189 (Art. 35), checked 19 October 2026

○ **Cyber Resilience Act, Article 14, applies** **11 September 2026 · in force as of the edition date**

Source: Regulation (EU) 2024/2847, Art. 71(2), checked 19 October 2026

○ **Machinery Regulation (EU) 2023/1230 applies**

14 January 2027 · 85 days after the edition date

Source: Regulation (EU) 2023/1230, Art. 54, checked 19 October 2026

○ **Cyber Resilience Act fully applies** **11 December 2027 · 416 days after the edition date**

Source: Regulation (EU) 2024/2847, Art. 71(2), checked 19 October 2026

PART 4

How remote access works in practice

Six common approaches, condensed. None is named here as better or worse than another; see **the fuller guide** for where each fits and exactly what to ask.

VPN into the customer network

An encrypted tunnel from the service engineer's device onto the customer's own network, broadly as though plugged in on site.

Trade-off: What the session can reach depends entirely on how the customer has segmented their own network, which can be considerably more than the one machine being serviced.

Remote support tools

Screen-sharing or remote-desktop style software for a session, usually started from the device being supported.

Trade-off: Easier to bound to a clear start and end, but varies widely in whether the session is logged or requires approval each time.

Jump hosts

A single hardened system placed between the outside connection and the OT network; anyone connecting remotely reaches it first.

Trade-off: Centralizes access and logging in one place, which also makes that one host the single thing standing between the outside and the OT network.

Cloud zero-trust access

Verifies the identity of a specific user and device for each connection to a specific resource, rather than trusting a network location.

Trade-off: Precise scoping like this usually depends on a cloud-hosted broker outside the customer's own network, which not every customer's policies accept.

OT gateway-based access

A dedicated gateway device at the edge of the OT network terminates the remote connection there rather than letting it continue onward.

Trade-off: Gives clearer certainty about scope, but adds a device the customer has to accept and the builder has to keep patched for the machine's life.

Hardware-enforced access

A physical control, such as a switch or key engaged on site, gates whether a remote connection can reach the machine at all.

Trade-off: Harder to bypass through a software compromise alone, but access then depends on someone being physically present to enable it.

PART 5

Trade-offs

Six dimensions worth weighing deliberately, each a genuine tension rather than a right answer. No approach or dimension is scored here.

Dimension	The tension
Identity	A named account per person is traceable but adds administrative overhead for every join, move, and leave; a shared account is simpler to provision but makes it impossible to say who actually connected.
Multi-factor authentication	Requiring a second factor closes the most commonly exploited single point of failure, but adds a step to every connection, including the urgent ones.
Scope of access	Scoping a connection to exactly one machine limits what a compromised session could reach, but is harder to set up and maintain than a connection that simply reaches the wider network.
Logging	A detailed session log is the clearest evidence after an incident, but detailed logs also cost more to store, retain, and actually review.
Third-party access	Letting a dealer or subcontractor connect under the same rules as direct staff keeps one consistent standard, but extends exactly who the customer has to trust.
Availability	Access that's always available removes delay during an urgent incident, but access that's switched on only on request gives the customer more control over when a third party can reach their systems.

PART 6

Buyer's evaluation matrix

Twenty-five requirements worth having an answer to, grouped by topic, each with why it matters and what to ask. This is a list of requirements to evaluate against, not a verdict on any product or vendor; it names none.

ACCESS MODEL

How access can be scoped

A connection that reaches more than it needs to widens what a single compromised session could expose.

Ask: Can access be scoped to one machine, or does it always reach more of the network?

How access is granted and revoked

Access that's slow to remove is access that outlives the reason it was given.

Ask: How is access granted for a new engineer, and how quickly can it be revoked?

IDENTITY AND MFA

Whether multi-factor authentication is required

A password alone is one of the most commonly exploited single points of failure.

Ask: Is MFA mandatory for every connection, or optional and up to us?

Whether accounts are named to a person or shared

Shared accounts make it impossible to trace who actually connected.

Ask: Can two engineers share one login, or is every account tied to a named person?

SESSION CONTROL

Who can start and stop a session

Customers increasingly expect to control a session they're exposed to, not just the vendor.

Ask: Can the customer end an active session themselves, at any time?

Whether sessions time out automatically

A session left open after the work is done is exposure with no offsetting benefit.

Ask: Does an idle session close itself, and after how long?

LOGGING AND EVIDENCE

What a session log actually captures

Logs are the main way an incident gets reconstructed after the fact, if they capture enough to be useful.

Ask: What does the session log capture: keystrokes, a screen recording, or just connection times?

How long logs are kept, and who can export them

A log that's deleted too soon, or that only the vendor can see, limits what it's actually worth as evidence.

Ask: How long are logs retained, and can we export our own copy?

DEPLOYMENT OPTIONS

Whether it runs on-premises, in the cloud, or both

Where the system runs affects what data leaves the customer's own environment and who else can see it.

Ask: Can this run entirely within our own network, or does it require a cloud component?

What has to be installed on the machine itself

Anything added to the machine is something that has to be maintained for the life of that machine.

Ask: What software or hardware has to be added to the machine, and who maintains it?

SUPPORTED PROTOCOLS AND DEVICES

Which industrial protocols and device types are supported

A tool that doesn't speak the protocols already in use adds a second system to maintain instead of replacing one.

Ask: Which protocols and controller types does this actually support today, not on a future roadmap?

Whether older or legacy equipment is supported

Most fleets include equipment that predates whatever is being evaluated now.

Ask: Does this work with the equipment already installed, or only with newer models?

LOW-BANDWIDTH AND OFFLINE SITES

How it behaves on a poor or intermittent connection

Many industrial sites don't have office-grade connectivity, and a tool that assumes they do fails exactly where it's needed most.

Ask: What happens to an active session if the connection drops, and does it work at all on a low-bandwidth link?

MULTI-CUSTOMER MANAGEMENT

How access across different customers is kept separate

A mistake that lets one customer's session reach another's systems is a serious failure, not a minor one.

Ask: How is one customer's access kept completely separate from another's?

Whether one dashboard can manage access across all customers

Managing access site-by-site, with no unified view, is itself an operational burden worth counting.

Ask: Can access across every customer site be seen and managed from one place?

CUSTOMER CONTROL OVER ACCESS

Whether the customer can see who currently has access

A customer's own security review depends on being able to see this themselves, not just take a vendor's word for it.

Ask: Can the customer see, in real time, exactly who currently has access?

Whether the customer can pause or revoke access without help

Depending on the vendor to remove access adds a delay a customer may not be able to accept during an incident.

Ask: Can the customer switch off access themselves, without contacting us first?

ONBOARDING EFFORT

What the customer has to do to get this running

Setup effort is a real cost, especially across many sites, and is worth sizing before committing.

Ask: What does the customer actually have to do to get this running at a new site?

How long onboarding typically takes

A rollout across many sites multiplies whatever the per-site setup time turns out to be.

Ask: Roughly how long does setup take, from agreement to a first working connection?

INTEGRATIONS WITH IDENTITY AND MONITORING TOOLS

Whether it connects to an existing identity provider

A separate set of accounts is another thing to manage, and another thing that can be forgotten when someone leaves.

Ask: Can this use an existing single sign-on, or does it need its own separate accounts?

Whether session data can feed existing monitoring tools

Logs that stay siloed in one tool are less likely to actually get reviewed alongside everything else.

Ask: Can session and log data be exported into the monitoring tools already in use?

SUPPORT AND REGIONS

What support is available, and where data is processed

Support hours and data location both affect how a problem at 2am, or a data-residency question, actually gets handled.

Ask: What hours is support available, in what time zones, and in which countries is data stored and processed?

PRICING MODEL CLARITY

Whether pricing is per user, per site, or per connection

A pricing basis that doesn't match how the tool is actually used tends to surprise everyone once it scales.

Ask: Is pricing based on users, sites, machines, or something else, and is that stated plainly?

Whether there are costs beyond the headline price

A quote that omits support, extra users, or extra sites isn't the real cost of running this.

Ask: Are there separate costs for support, extra users, or extra sites beyond the quoted price?

DATA PORTABILITY

Whether logs and configuration can be exported if switching providers

Being unable to take your own records with you is a real cost of switching later, worth knowing up front.

Ask: If this is stopped, can the logs and configuration be exported, or are they locked in?

Get the full 25-criteria vendor comparison checklist as an editable spreadsheet, with blank columns for your own requirement and up to three vendors' answers.

PART 7

Illustrative scenarios

Three generic, fictional situations, labelled illustrative throughout, used only to show which rules and trade-offs a situation like it touches. None describes a real company.

ILLUSTRATIVE

A machine builder shipping packaging lines across both countries

A mid-sized machine builder sells packaging lines to food and beverage plants in both Belgium and the Netherlands, with service engineers who connect in remotely for diagnostics and the occasional firmware update.

What it touches: The Cyber Resilience Act and the Machinery Regulation apply to the machine itself regardless of the builder's own size. If a customer is itself in NIS2 scope, Article 21(2)(d) gives that customer a documented reason to ask how the builder's remote access is secured, even though NIS2 does not bind the builder directly at this size.

ILLUSTRATIVE

A factory operator with several vendors holding remote access

A factory operator runs equipment from several different machine builders, each with their own remote-access arrangement into parts of the plant network.

What it touches: If the operator is itself in NIS2 scope, Article 21(2)(d) requires assessing the security practices of each of those direct suppliers, not just the operator's own internal controls. The questions in Part 6 of this report are the kind an operator in this position would need an answer to from each vendor.

ILLUSTRATIVE

A system integrator maintaining machines it did not build

A system integrator services and maintains machines on behalf of several machine builders and plant operators, connecting remotely to equipment across customer sites it does not own.

What it touches: An integrator in this position can sit on both sides of the supply-chain pressure described above: asked by its own customers to evidence its practices, while needing the same evidence from any machine builder whose equipment it services under its own name.

PART 8

A 90-day action plan

Days 1-30

- Run the free scope checker and remote access review sheet to establish, in writing, which rules likely apply and what today's remote-access setup actually looks like.
- Confirm the national authority, registration step, and incident-reporting duty that applies in each country of operation, from the official sources this report cites.
- Identify every third party, dealer, or subcontractor who currently holds remote access, and on what terms.

Days 31-60

- Compare current practice against each row of the buyer's evaluation matrix in Part 7, regardless of whether a vendor change is planned, to see which questions already have a confident answer and which don't.
- Prepare the evidence a customer's own security questionnaire is likely to ask for: access lists, logging retention, and incident-response documentation.
- Confirm, in writing, who owns the decision on remote-access policy internally, and who would be the point of contact for a customer's security question.

Days 61-90

- If evaluating or changing a remote-access approach, use the full 25-criteria vendor comparison checklist to structure that evaluation before any demo.
- Resolve any open question flagged in the review sheet: anything marked 'not sure' is worth a definite answer before a customer asks it first.
- Revisit the regulatory timeline against the current date, and confirm nothing material has changed in either country's implementing law.

PART 9

Sources and methodology

Every regulatory date and country-specific fact in this report comes from the compliance ledger maintained for this site, cited inline with the official source and the date it was last checked. Every enterprise and employment figure comes from Eurostat's dissemination API, dataset sbs_sc_ovw, extracted 2026-10-21, with the Netherlands cross-checked against a CBS (Statistics Netherlands) business-register table; the Belgian figures rest on Eurostat alone, since no comparable figure could be resolved from Statbel's API within this extraction. Full methodology, raw API responses, and exact query URLs: see this site's public source citations throughout this report, each linking the official page.

Regulatory dates cited

NIS2 in force in Belgium (Law of 26 April 2024): **18 October 2024**. Source: Law of 26 April 2024 (Moniteur belge), Art. 98, checked 19 October 2026

Cyberbeveiligingswet (NIS2) in force in the Netherlands: **15 August 2026**. Source: Staatsblad 2026, 187 and 189 (Art. 35), checked 19 October 2026

Cyber Resilience Act, Article 14, applies: **11 September 2026**. Source: Regulation (EU) 2024/2847, Art. 71(2), checked 19 October 2026

Machinery Regulation (EU) 2023/1230 applies: **14 January 2027**. Source: Regulation (EU) 2023/1230, Art. 54, checked 19 October 2026

Cyber Resilience Act fully applies: **11 December 2027**. Source: Regulation (EU) 2024/2847, Art. 71(2), checked 19 October 2026

Enterprise and employment data

Eurostat, dataset sbs_sc_ovw (Enterprise statistics by size class and NACE Rev. 2 activity (from 2021 onwards)), 2024 figures, extracted 21 October 2026. Query used.

CBS (Statistics Netherlands) cross-check, table 81589NED, SBI code 28, Q4 2026 (provisional, per CBS), extracted 21 October 2026. Query used.

Statbel's open-data portal and API were reachable on the extraction date, but no directly comparable published size-class breakdown for NACE 28 could be resolved. Belgium's figures in this report rest on Eurostat alone.

Full extraction methodology and raw API responses are recorded in this project's own documentation at the time of publication. No number in this report is modeled, projected, or estimated; every number traces to one of the sources above or to the compliance ledger entries listed earlier in this report.